

Star struck

I am a 17-year-old college student, and I must admit that though your magazine stands out in the market place, there is still an iggly-wiggly complaint about you guys.

The wallpapers, movie trailers and numerous games that feature on your Playware CD are indeed superb. But really, why don't you guys include wallpapers of Hollywood superstars on your CD? I am sure that pictures of Cameron Diaz, Leonardo Di Caprio, etc, would look better on the desktop.

Poornima Menon
Mumbai

Dear Poornima
Wouldn't we love Tom Cruise or Penelope Cruz on our wallpaper, too! We will try and incorporate your suggestion soon.

digit

Fast, but serviceless

Yo Digit! In a previous edition of Tips and Tricks, I saw the several tips that would make my PC work faster. Now, here is the problem: I tried your suggestions one by one, and boy were my games fast! But (and there is always a but) ever since then, I have had a real tough time trying to start the services all over again, in order to use dial-up networking.

There is a sequence in which you have to start these services (I haven't figured it out yet, but trial and error worked for me) as most services are dependent on each other. How could you guys not give the correct tip?

Arun Thilak

Dear reader,
The box 'At Your Service', in the May 2004 Tips and Tricks article, details how to go about creating hardware profiles for each specific use of your PC. If you notice we had specifically asked you to "Use different hardware profiles for different service configurations."

digit

Kissa Kursi Ka

I live in a small city, and a magazine like Digit is the only reliable source of technology information to me. But surely, be it for big city guys or small city denizens, the one big problem that is common for both is the question of which chair to buy while working on the PC. Wrongly selected, the chair could be nothing less than hell. So what should be the right chair to buy?

Tarun Shrivastava

Illustrations: Mahesh Benkar



Dear Tarun,

There are three ways of tackling this problem:

- Improve your posture
- Select the chair has good lower-back support, and...
- Keep moving out of your work area as often as you can

The straight-back posture is the best because the human vertebral column is not geared to bend for long periods of time, which is how most people sit while working

The lower part is always the worst affected when it comes to back problems. The human back requires the most support in the lower portion, and any chair that gives you enough lower-back support should be a good one.

Try and move out of your work area a bit. Bend down, stretch a bit every half hour, or take a five-minute walk every couple of hours.

Believe us, your back problem would be cured just by doing these little things.

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Gmail for mail

I was astounded to see the response to the May 2004 survey question. Majority of the participants have shown preference for Hotmail or Yahoo! over Google Mail. I feel that there will be a big variance if the question is framed this way: "Taking into consideration the overall features and the underlying technology along with 1 GB space, which e-mail service provider will you choose."

I am sure that Gmail would then get more points. I also doubt if the users know about the complete features announced by Gmail.

I feel Gmail will be preferred more, because of its underlying technology and its obligation to perform well, especially after Google has announced its firm plans to go public.

I might sound very optimistic here, especially since only a few people have seen the e-mail service yet, but I am confident that there will be no goof ups by the Google team with regards to their service. The only minus point with Gmail is Google's announcement of not launching its e-mail service with a POP3, HTTP or IMAP support.

Surya Prakash Pasupaty

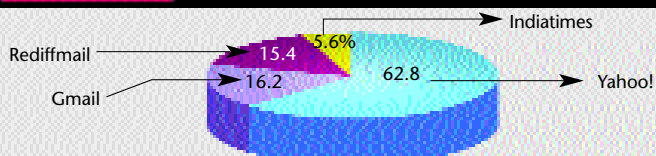
Dear Surya Prakash

Gmail's 1000 MB service in itself will be a point of attraction for several e-mail users. Imagine having 1000 MB of mails with search capability! Yes, the lack of POP3 support may be a drawback, but the success of Gmail does not just depend on just its features, but its reliability. In case you were not aware, www.spymac.com already has a 1000 MB free e-mail service, and yet, it is yet to be even talked about because of its unreliable e-mail engine. Hence, for those unlucky people who have not been allotted a Gmail account, it will be still be a wait and watch strategy.

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Your vote counts



Who among the following biggies, if they offer a free 1 GB mailbox, would you prefer the most

Responses: 7046

This month's question...

Which of these five technologies do you think will make it big in the next 12 months?

- ☐ Computing Convergence ☐ E-paper ☐ Bayesian Spam Filters
☐ Sub-15,000 PCs ☐ P2P VOIP

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote